

Problem 3: Tenji Braille

Here are five Japanese words and their corresponding Tenji Braille³ transliterations:

asa	morning	
kaigi	meeting	
fukuro	pocket	
sakura	cherry blossom	
otokonoko	boy	

²Sarangani Manobo is one of the languages comprising the Manobo subgroup within the Philippine branch of the Austronesian language family. It is spoken by an estimated twenty thousand people living on the east coast of the Sarangani Peninsula and another ten thousand people living on the San Agustin Peninsula of southern Mindanao.

³Japanese Braille is the braille script of the Japanese language. It is based on the original braille script, though the connection is tenuous. In Japanese it is known as *tenji*, literally “dot characters”.

Here are some more Japanese words and their Tenji Braille transliterations, in no particular order:

1. ikimono	living creatures	A. 
2. nezumi	mouse	B. 
3. sora	sky	C. 
4. shinzo	heart	D. 
5. ushiro	behind	E. 
6. hi	fire	F. 
7. kinoko	mushroom	G. 
8. mugi	wheat	H. 
9. bangohan	supper	I. 
10. mame	beans	J. 

Assignment 1: (10 marks)

Match the Japanese words (1-10) to their Tenji Braille transliterations (A-J).

Assignment 2: (5 marks)

Transliterate the following words to Tenji Braille:

i. geri	diarrhea
ii. kirin	giraffe
iii. saba	mackerel
iv. hotaru	firefly
v. atsumaru	to gather

– Apoorva Bhagwat and Sandipan Dandapat
